

GRAMMAR LESSON PLAN

Topic: Quantifiers for Count & Noncount Nouns

Grammar Focus: much, many, a lot of, a few, a little, few, little, too much, too many, not enough

Course: Academic A Applied Grammar

Lesson by: Shantona Mir

Length: 60 minutes

1. CONTEXT DESCRIPTION

Class Profile:

Academic A students at the BYU ELC. Mostly international students aged 18–45. English proficiency at Intermediate-Mid to Intermediate-High according to ACTFL.

Purpose for Learning:

Students need to describe amount and quantity accurately in academic and daily contexts, such as:

- explaining workload
- describing routines
- talking about food & money
- reporting research findings
- summarizing data in reading passages

Prior Knowledge:

Students can identify count vs noncount nouns at a basic level. They can use simple present, simple past, and present perfect (from Lesson Plan 1). However, they struggle to use quantifiers accurately and often mix “much/many,” misuse “too much/too many,” and place quantifiers incorrectly.

Learning Objectives:

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Recognize quantifiers in context and infer meaning.
2. Distinguish quantifiers used with count vs noncount nouns.
3. Produce accurate sentences using quantifiers.
4. Apply quantifiers in real-world communicative situations.

P — PRESENTATION (10 minutes)

(Comprehensible Input through Story)

Total Time: 10 minutes

Mode: Reading + initial noticing

Instructions (Introducing the topic and giving students a purpose):

“Today we’re going to explore how to talk about amounts or degree in English, something you already do every day without noticing. Knowing how to comprehend and express amounts and degree appropriately is very important for all four skill areas to show clear meaning, accurate description, and precise communication in both academic and everyday contexts.” (30 seconds)

Warm-up (3-4 minutes): Checking their prior knowledge (Bring a bowl of M&M for prop): “This bowl of candy is our ‘life problem.’ Sometimes there’s not enough, sometimes there’s a little, sometimes there are too many. I’ll change the amount of candy, and together we’ll choose the best words: a lot of, much, many, a little, a few, little, few, too much, too many, not enough, some (write them down on the board). Who can tell us what we call these words that suggests amounts in English?” Wait for 10 seconds, and then tell them we call them Quantifiers, and they probably have heard of it before.

Instruction for Teacher : Step 1 – Silent Observation – Creating curiosity

1. Put the empty bowl at the front.
2. Pour candies next to the bowl (but not in yet).
3. Say:

“Just look for a moment. Don’t say anything yet. We’re going to use this candy to talk about amounts.”

Step 2 – Teacher Models First

Teacher will physically change the amount and say a sentence each time. (Model twice)
Students will answer, and then teacher will confirm the answer.

1. Put 4 candies in the bowl.

Teacher says:

“Now there are four candies in the bowl.
Should I call this a few candies or many candies?”

2. Add 10–12 candies so the bowl looks full.

Teacher says:

“Now look, the bowl is much fuller.

Which word should we use from the board?”

3. Add even more candies until the bowl is overflowing.

Teacher says:

“Okay... now this is definitely too many candies.

For one person, this is just too much candy. Which quantifier (s) from the board can we use?”

(No explanations will be given on this stage, and save the questions for later)

Step 4 : Transition to the story/ input : “Great, since we know quantifiers a little better now, now we’re going to read about an international student who has ‘too much’ and ‘too many’ problems in their life. We will read the story twice. First, I will read it with you guys. You will go through the reading silently as you listen to me reading. Together, we will try to get the general idea of the story. Focus only on the story.”

Teacher distributes printed copies of the story.

Story: “A Week in the Life of an International Student”

(Students read silently and listen while teacher reads aloud.)

MONDAY:

The week started with too much homework left over from the weekend. When I checked Canvas, there were too many announcements to read quickly, so I spent a lot of time catching up. I grabbed a little breakfast, but it wasn’t enough to keep me full.

TUESDAY:

Because I had slept very little, I needed a lot of coffee just to stay awake. I had a few minutes before class, so I reviewed some notes. Even though it wasn’t much time, it helped me feel more prepared.

WEDNESDAY:

My professor assigned a lot of projects, and I realized I had not enough time to finish everything. I spent a little money on snacks to stay energized and a few dollars on the bus because I was running late.

THURSDAY:

By Thursday, I felt overwhelmed. I had too much reading, too many deadlines, and definitely not enough sleep. I took a few short breaks, but they didn’t make a big difference.

FRIDAY:

When Friday finally arrived, I had some free time, so I watched a lot of videos and ate too

many chips while relaxing. Later, I remembered I still had too much laundry waiting for me, which destroyed my good mood.

Instructions:

Now read again by yourself. Ask yourself and answer the comprehension questions from the reading.

☺ Why was the student so overwhelmed during the week?
(Think about what they had too much of or not enough of.)

☺ What did the student have too many of?

What did the student do when they finally had free time? Did it help them feel better? Why or why not?

☺ What did the student not have enough of?

☺ Which day was the most overwhelming?

(Share the answer with each other if they have time)

A — ATTENTION (15 minutes)

Total Time: 15 minutes

Mode: Underlining - Sorting - Meaning discussion -Visual mapping

The purpose here is to help students notice form and meaning before any explicit explanation.

Step 1: Identifying Quantifiers (3 minutes)

Instruction: Reread the story and underline any phrase showing amount or degree.

(Students already know what phrases are! If the explanation is needed again, the teacher can simply say “A phrase is a group of words that acts as one unit of meaning but does not have both a subject and a verb, so it is not a complete sentence. Example: too much homework.)

Teacher Note (Likely Student Findings Based on the story):

- too much homework
- too many announcements
- a lot of time
- a little breakfast
- not enough
- very little
- a lot of coffee
- a few minutes
- some notes
- a lot of projects

- not enough time
- a little money
- a few dollars
- too much reading
- too many deadlines
- not enough sleep
- a few short breaks
- some free time
- a lot of videos
- too many chips
- too much laundry

Step 2: Sorting Phrases Into Categories (5 minutes)

Instruction: “ You will work in pairs and complete this worksheet. You will sort the quantifier phrases you underlined into three categories. Put them in boxes based on the types of nouns they go with.”

Count nouns	
Noncount nouns	
Both	

Teacher Note (Expected Student Output):

Count nouns (phrases):

- too many announcements
- a few minutes
- a few dollars
- too many deadlines

- a few short breaks
- too many chips
- a lot of videos
- a lot of projects

Noncount nouns (phrases):

- too much homework
- a lot of time
- a little breakfast
- not enough (breakfast/food implied)
- a lot of coffee
- some notes (uncountable as a concept here)
- not enough time
- a little money
- too much reading
- not enough sleep
- too much laundry

Both (phrases where quantifier works with both types):

- some free time
- some notes
- a lot of coffee / a lot of time
- not enough sleep / not enough time
- a lot of videos

(This helps students recognize patterns in how quantifiers behave.)

Step 3: Meaning Discussion (4 minutes)

Teacher leads students to interpret meaning, not grammar rules.

Teacher asks:

- “Which quantifier phrases describe problems?”
- “Which phrases describe large amounts?”
- “Which phrases describe small amounts?”
- “Which ones suggest the student was overwhelmed?”
- “Which ones could be used in both academic and daily life contexts?”

Students discuss in pairs and then share as a class to link quantifiers to meaning.

Step 4: Visual Mapping of Degree (3 minutes)

To make the degree difference visually clear, teacher draws an “amount scale” on the board:

TOO MUCH / TOO MANY

↑

A LOT OF

↑

SOME

↑

A FEW / A LITTLE

↑

VERY LITTLE / FEW

↑

NOT ENOUGH

Students take the phrases from the story and place them on the scale.

Examples:

- Top: too much reading, too many deadlines
- High: a lot of coffee, a lot of projects
- Middle: some notes, some free time
- Lower: a few minutes, a little breakfast
- Low: very little sleep
- Bottom: not enough time, not enough sleep

4. C — CO-CONSTRUCTION (15 minutes)

Time: 15 minutes

Step 1: Build the Rule Chart With Students (5 minutes)

Teacher draws:

Count Nouns
Non-Count Nouns
Both

Instruction:

“Earlier, you sorted phrases. Now we’re going to use those patterns to build the grammar rules together.” Students will call out quantifiers (just the quantifiers, without the whole phrase) while the teacher fills the chart.

Final Chart (built with students):
• Count Nouns: many, a few, few, too many

Noncount Nouns: much, a little, little, too much
Both: some, a lot of, enough / not enough

Teacher briefly confirms:

- “We use these with count nouns because they refer to numbers.”
- “We use these with noncount nouns because they refer to amounts.”
- “These can work with both because they do not depend on number.”

Step 2: Clarifying Meaning Through Concept Questions (5 minutes)

Teacher asks students to create the rules verbally:

“Why do we say too many deadlines but too much reading?”

Deadlines are countable; reading is noncount.

“What is the difference between a few and few?”

A few = some (positive)	few = almost none (negative).
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“What is the difference between a little and little?”

A little = some (positive)	little = almost none (negative).
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“Why can not enough be used with both?”

It describes sufficiency	not number.
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Teacher writes a short summary on the board:

Count = number	Noncount = amount	Both = flexible.
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Step 3: Controlled Accuracy Practice (5 minutes)

Students fix errors using the rules they helped build.

Fix the Quantifier:

- “I don’t have much friends.”
- “We have too many homework.”

3. "I eat a few rice every day."
4. "She has not enough times to rest."
5. "They drank too many water."

Students check answers in pairs - teacher confirms.

E — EXTENSION (20 minutes)

Task: "Campus Resources Quantity Survey & Report"
(Students use quantifiers to describe realistic university resources and student behaviors.)

Step 1: Group Formation (1 minute)

Students work in groups of 4 (5 groups).

Step 2: Campus Resource Cards (3 minutes)

Each group receives one card describing a common university resource category.

Resource Card A: Library Use

- | |
|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • available books • quiet study spaces • online articles • overdue books (common issue) • printing credit |
|---|

Resource Card B: Learning Center Support
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- | |
|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • tutoring sessions • conversation groups • academic workshops • sign-ups during finals week • open appointments |
|--|

Resource Card C: Campus Transportation
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- | |
|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • bus routes • delays • traffic around campus • walking distance between buildings • bike racks |
|---|

Resource Card D: Fitness & Recreation Center
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- | |
|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • equipment |
|---|

- group classes
- open lockers
- many people during peak hours
- space in the stretching area

Resource Card E: Dining Services

- meal options
- snacks
- healthy choices
- waste at lunchtime
- seats during rush hours

Teacher prints out 5 cards.

Step 3: Task Instructions (1 minute)

“Create a 6-8 sentence report describing how students use this campus resource. Use at least eight different quantifiers in your description. Write complete sentences that describe availability, access, or student behavior.”

Step 4: Group Work Time (8 minutes)

Students collaborate to write a clear paragraph describing their resource. Teacher circulates and provides light scaffolding.

Step 5: Presentations (6 minutes)

Each group reads their report aloud.

Audience Task:

Students listening must write down as many quantifiers as they hear from each group. The group that writes down the most quantifiers wins, and the group that uses all their quantifiers appropriately also wins.

6. PEDAGOGICAL RATIONALE

The Presentation stage provides comprehensible, context-rich input so learners encounter quantifiers naturally before analyzing them.

The Attention stage helps students consciously notice quantifier patterns through guided noticing tasks, supporting form–meaning connections.

The Co-construction stage allows students to collaboratively build grammar rules with teacher scaffolding, strengthening conceptual understanding.

The Extension stage gives learners meaningful opportunities to use quantifiers in authentic communication through a task-based activity.

7. POST-IT NOTE VERSION

1. Warm-up: M&M prop - elicit quantifiers (a lot of, many, much, a few, a little, too much, etc.)
2. Presentaion: Story: Read “A Week in the Life...” - students underline quantifier phrases
3. Attention: Sort phrases into count / noncount / both - discuss meaning - place on amount scale
4. Co-construction: Build quantifier rule chart together - concept questions - fix 5 error sentences
5. Extension: Campus Resources Survey - groups create 6–8 sentence report using ≥8 quantifiers - present - listeners write quantifiers they hear

8. FEEDBACK SECTION

Lesson #2

Marilyn

This was an excellent lesson! It was carefully crafted to carry the students from one part into the next! Some things I liked:

1. The objectives are clear, and reasons are given for why the learning is valuable.
2. The M&M opener definitely pulls students into the lesson.
3. With the reading, students are assigned a purpose both times.
4. The reading selection relates to them.
5. There are enough samples given to see patterns in the quantifiers.
6. The graphic organizer for the nouns—count/noncount/both, and the visual mapping scale simplify concepts that could be confusing.
7. There is variety in independent, pair, group, and whole class activities.
8. Good co-construction questions guide students to build the grammar rule.
9. The campus resources extension is very applicable to students.
10. The lesson is written clearly so another teacher can follow it.

Recommendations: I feel this lesson is good as is. A few things that might be helpful are:
Using simpler wording when introducing the topic to students.

Adding additional pedagogical reasoning for your activities. They are good, and there is purpose in using them, so just stating some of that.

An alternative extension that would require students to negotiate with each other—a jigsaw or even a role play in which they purchase commodities of count/noncount nouns with quantifiers would focus on verbal rather than written output. This isn't necessarily better than the written output, just different.

Bích :

I like how you use different activities to teach the concept. They are engaging, especially because they include physical demonstrations, which help students understand more easily. The topics you chose—like school, homework, and candy—are also familiar to students, so they can learn the grammar points more easily.

For the pedagogical rationale, it might be better to write it right after each activity. This will make it clear how each activity connects to the teaching principles you are using.